

English 1301-This I Believe Essay

English 1301 - This I Believe Essay Assignment Specifications: 1 ½ -2 Two pages, typed, double-spaced, MLA FORMAT, FINAL DRAFT SUBMITTED Canvas.

In this essay you are going to write a personal essay stating your one core belief. Be sure to explore the “This I Believe” website before you write. Also, you might want to look at the student examples before starting. Here are some more tips.

Tell a story: Be specific. Take your belief out of the ether and ground it in the events of your life. Consider moments when belief was formed or tested or changed. Think of your own experience, work, and family, Tell about the things you know that no one else does. Your story does not need to be heart-warming or gut-wrenching—it can even be funny—but it should be real. Make sure your story ties to the essence of your daily life philosophy and the shaping of your beliefs.

Be brief: Your statement should be about 1½ - 2 pages. That’s about three minutes when read aloud at your natural pace. The shorter length forces you to focus on the belief that is central to your life.

Name your belief: If you can’t name it in a sentence or two, your essay might not be about belief. Remember to focus on one core belief.

Be positive: Say what you do believe, not what you don’t believe. Avoid statements of religious dogma or preaching. In other words, I do not want your testimony.

Be personal: Make your essay about you; speak in the first person. Avoid speaking in the editorial “we.” Write in words and phrases that are comfortable for you to speak. Read your essay aloud to yourself several times, and each time edit it and simplify it until you find the words, tone, and story that truly echoes your belief and the way you speak.

Here is a possible outline structure for you to follow:

- 1) First Paragraph:
 - a) Hook

- b) Intro
 - c) Belief (Thesis)
- 2) Second Paragraph:
 - a) First Supporting Reason for Belief
- 3) Third Paragraph:
 - a) Second Supporting Reason for Belief
- 4) Fourth Paragraph
 - a) Third Supporting Reason for Belief
- 5) Conclusion
 - a) Restate Belief
 - b) Closing Remark

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